Short-Form Content Addiction and Attention Fragmentation Among University Students: Implications for Deep Learning and Academic Burnout

Dear Participant,

You are invited to participate in this research study examining how short-form digital content consumption (e.g., TikTok, Facebook Reels, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts) influences attention, learning engagement, and academic wellbeing among university students.

Your participation is completely voluntary. All responses will remain anonymous and confidential. No personally identifying information will be collected. The survey will take approximately 10–15 minutes to complete.

By proceeding, you confirm that:

- You are currently enrolled in a university.
- You are at least 16 years old.
- You voluntarily agree to participate.

* Indicates required question

1. **Consent Question** *

Mark only one oval.

I voluntarily agree to participate in this research.

SECTION B: DEMOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

2. Age *

Mark only one oval.

- Under 16
- 16–20
- 21–23
- 24–26
- Above 26

3. Gender *

Mark only one oval.

- Male
- Female

4. University Type *

Mark only one oval.

- Public University
- Private University
- Other

5. Current Academic Level *

Mark only one oval.

- Undergraduate
- Master's
- MPhil
- PhD

6. Academic Discipline *

Mark only one oval.

- Engineering/Technology
- Business/Economics
- Social Sciences
- Arts/Humanities
- Medical/Health Sciences
- Science
- Other

7. Year of Study *

Mark only one oval.

- ◯ 1st Year
- ◯ 2nd Year
- ◯ 3rd Year
- ◯ 4th Year
- ◯ Graduate Level

8. Average Daily Time Spent on Short-Form Content Platforms (TikTok, Facebook Reels, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts) *

Mark only one oval.

- ◯ Less than 30 minutes
- ◯ 30 minutes–1 hour
- ◯ 1–2 hours
- ◯ 2–4 hours
- ◯ More than 4 hours

9. Which platform do you use most frequently? *

Check all that apply.

- ☐ TikTok
- ☐ Facebook Reels
- ☐ Instagram Reels
- ☐ YouTube Shorts
- ☐ Other: _____

10. How frequently do you check short-form content platforms during study time? *

Mark only one oval.

- Never
- Rarely
- Sometimes
- Often
- Very Often
- Always

SECTION C: SHORT-FORM CONTENT ADDICTION SCALE (SFCA)

Instructions

Please indicate your level of agreement with the following statements.

Scale:
1 = Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Neutral, 4 = Agree, 5 = Strongly Agree

Dimension 1: Compulsive Consumption Untitled Title

11. SFCA1. I often open short-form content apps without intending to. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

12. SFCA2. I continue scrolling even when I know I should stop. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

13. SFCA3. I feel an urge to check reels/shorts repeatedly throughout the day. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

14. SFCA4. I lose track of time while watching short-form content. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 2: Psychological Dependence

15. SFCA5. I feel restless when I cannot access short-form content platforms. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

16. SFCA6. Watching reels/shorts has become part of my daily routine. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

17. SFCA7. I feel bored quickly without short-form digital stimulation. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

18. SFCA8. I use short-form content to escape academic pressure or stress. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 3: Study Interference

19. SFCA9. Short-form content interrupts my study sessions. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

20. SFCA10. I check reels/shorts even during academic activities. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

21. SFCA11. My concentration on academic tasks decreases after prolonged scrolling. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

22. SFCA12. I postpone academic work because of short-form content use. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 4: Cognitive Stimulation Dependency

23. SFCA13. I prefer fast and highly stimulating content over long academic materials. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

24. SFCA14. Long lectures or readings feel mentally difficult after consuming short-form content. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

25. SFCA15. I become impatient when learning materials are not immediately engaging. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

26. SFCA16. I frequently switch between apps while studying. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

SECTION D: ATTENTION FRAGMENTATION (AF) SCALE

Dimension 1: Sustained Attention Difficulty (AD)

27. AF1. I find it difficult to focus on one task for a long time. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

28. AF2. My attention shifts quickly while studying. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

29. AF3. I struggle to maintain concentration during lectures. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

30. AF4. I become mentally distracted even during important academic activities. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 2: Cognitive Switching

31. AF5. I frequently multitask during study sessions. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

32. AF6. I switch between study materials and social media repeatedly. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

33. AF7. I feel uncomfortable focusing on one activity without checking my phone. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

34. AF8. My mind jumps rapidly from one thought to another. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 3: Deep Focus Erosion

35. AF9. I find it harder to read long academic texts than before. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

36. AF10. I struggle to engage deeply with complex academic materials. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

37. AF11. I lose interest quickly when tasks require prolonged mental effort. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

38. AF12. I prefer short and fast information over detailed explanations. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

SECTION E: NOTIFICATION OVERLOAD (NO) SCALE

39. NO1. I receive too many notifications daily. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

40. NO2. Notifications frequently interrupt my concentration. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

41. NO3. I feel mentally overwhelmed by constant digital alerts. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

42. NO4. I immediately check notifications even during study sessions. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

43. NO5. Notifications make it difficult for me to maintain focus. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

SECTION F: COGNITIVE FATIGUE (CF) SCALE

44. CF1. I feel mentally exhausted after long periods of digital media use. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

45. CF2. Continuous scrolling leaves me feeling cognitively drained. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

46. CF3. I experience difficulty concentrating after excessive social media use. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

47. CF4. My brain feels overloaded from constant digital stimulation. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

48. CF5. I feel mentally tired even when I have not done substantial academic work. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

SECTION G: DEEP LEARNING ENGAGEMENT (DLE) SCALE

Dimension 1: Reflective Learning

49. DLE1. I try to understand concepts deeply rather than memorize information. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

50. DLE2. I connect new knowledge with previously learned ideas. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

51. DLE3. I critically analyze academic materials during study. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

52. DLE4. I enjoy engaging with intellectually challenging topics. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 2: Sustained Academic Engagement

53. DLE5. I can remain focused on academic work for extended periods. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

54. DLE6. I invest significant mental effort in understanding course materials. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

55. DLE7. I actively reflect on what I learn. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

56. DLE8. I persist even when academic tasks are mentally demanding. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 3: Deep Reading & Conceptual Processing

57. DLE9. I regularly read long-form academic materials carefully. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

58. DLE10. I prefer detailed explanations over simplified summaries. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

59. DLE11. I can maintain attention while reading academic texts. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

60. DLE12. I enjoy exploring complex ideas in depth. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

SECTION H: ACADEMIC BURNOUT (AB) SCALE

Dimension 1: Emotional Exhaustion

61. AB1. I feel emotionally exhausted because of academic demands. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

62. AB2. I feel mentally drained by my studies. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

63. AB3. Academic responsibilities feel overwhelming to me. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

64. AB4. I often feel too tired to study effectively. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 2: Academic Disengagement

65. AB5. I feel less interested in my academic work than before. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

66. AB6. I struggle to stay motivated academically. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

67. AB7. I sometimes feel detached from my studies. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

68. AB8. I often study only to complete requirements rather than to learn. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Dimension 3: Reduced Academic Efficacy

69. AB9. I doubt my ability to perform well academically. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

70. AB10. I feel less productive academically than I used to. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

71. AB11. I find it difficult to maintain academic consistency. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

72. AB12. I feel that my academic performance is declining. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

SECTION I: SELF-REGULATION (SR) SCALE (Moderator)

73. SR1. I can control my urge to check social media while studying. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

74. SR2. I manage my study time effectively. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

75. SR3. I can resist distractions when working on important tasks. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

76. SR4. I set clear academic goals for myself. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

77. SR5. I remain disciplined even when digital distractions are available. *

Mark only one oval.

1	2	3	4	5
◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Thank you for taking the time to participate in this research.
Your valuable responses will contribute to a deeper understanding of how short-form digital content influences attention, learning behavior, and academic wellbeing among university students.

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